

Mental Health

How to Be a Mental Health Ally

by Katherine Ponte

May 9, 2022



André Rocha/EyeEm/Getty Images

Summary. Research shows that someone you know — a colleague, a family member, a friend, a client, a board member, or even yourself — will experience a mental health challenge at some point in your life. Recognizing this possibility can arm yourself in... [more](#)

HBR



HBR Executive

Innovation starts with how you lead. Discover the habits and mindsets that fuel breakthrough thinking.

Start Your Subscription Now

dealing with mental health issues with the empathy you would want under similar circumstances.



Katherine Ponte is the founder of [ForLikeMinds](#), a board member of the [National Alliance on Mental Illness–New York City](#), a lecturer of psychiatry with the [Program for Recovery and Community Health](#) at Yale University’s School of Medicine, a blogger for the National Alliance on Mental Illness, author and coauthor of articles published in leading psychiatric journals, and the author of [ForLikeMinds: Mental Illness Recovery Insights](#). Katherine has been living with severe bipolar I disorder with psychosis, including major depressive disorder, for over 20 years. She is now happily living in recovery.



Read more on **Mental health** or related topics **Health and wellness**, **Difficult conversations**, **Diversity and inclusion**, **Disabilities**, **Health and behavioral science**, **Management communication**, **Managing yourself**, **Interpersonal communication**, **Personnel policies**, **Time-off policies**, **Flex time**, **Organizational change** and **Work environments**

HBR



HBR Executive

Innovation starts with how you lead. Discover the habits and mindsets that fuel breakthrough thinking.

Start Your Subscription Now